The Mountainside

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CMA's Community Infrastructure: What You Don't See!

by Jackson Bain - editor

The great marjority of Coolfont homeowners never consider all the work that goes into improving or maintaining the systems we all depend upon - and which keep our homes at Coolfont supplied with the basic needs we all share - good road access, pure water and efficient sewer service.

Of course, electricity and telephone services are also important, but those services are the responsibility of those commercial utility companies, not the Coolfont Mountainside Association.

Here on the mountainside, we can take pride in the knowledge that much hard work by your neighbors has given us an infrastructure that works very well in this challenging environment, and that is built to last. These improvements have cost much volunteer time and considerable money, but the results have been worth the cost.

A Little History

When the first homes at Coolfont were built, things were different. The codes and regulations of the state were not as rigidly written or enforced, and the first roads and water/sewer systems were not up to the standard of today. The Coolfont Mountainside Association took over the maintenance and control of all these systems from the developer in the 1970's, and since then, the community has steadily funded new installations and improvements.

The new water and sewer system installed in 1999-2000 has already shown its worth in reducing the number of leaks and other problems, which added to the annual operations cost. The repaving of the North and South Mountainside Road has resulted in fewer weather related problems - also costly. The improvements now underway at the swimming pool will make that area even nicer and more useful by adding bathrooms and a CMA office. All of this work was done by your neighbors, volunteers all -and was made possible by our assessments and water fees.

Now, what would you like to see improved? Join the volunteers and make it happen!

CMA BOARD NOMINATIONS NOW OPEN

Want to give back something to CMA? Have skills you are willing to share? Have an interest in the future of CMA? The Nominating Committee is now accepting nominations (self-nominations welcome) for the CMA Board. To make a nomination, contact Nancy Thompson at 703-684-8465 or at jthompso@erols.com.

CMA Board Meetings and Pot Luck Dinner Schedule

Sat., March 17

Board Meeting:

Broxson H-8

Potluck:

Bender home K-3

Sat., April 21

Board Meeting:

Bradfield N-3

Potluck:

Yingling J-2

Sat., May 19

Board Meeting:

Dring O-1

1:30 p.m. POOL CLEANUP

POTLUCK PARTY - The Barn

Sat., June 16

Board Meeting:

Hash F-4

Potluck: The Barn

Sat: July 21

Board Meeting:

9:00 a.m. Treetops

ANNUAL MEETING:

1:00 p.m. Treetops

CMA DINNER:

6:30 p.m. The Barn

Social and Communications Committee

After a winter hiatus, we are gearing up for renewal of our potluck suppers. We continue to solicit volunteers to host the potluck suppers and if anyone is interested they should contact Committee Chair Joan Hash. We are pleased to say that Florence Bender (K-3) will be hosting our March potluck. All are invited to come out and join us there on MARCH 17th for a ST. PATTY's DAY celebration.

We'd also like to note that the Social and Recreation Committees will jointly sponsor the MAY potluck in the BARN on May 19th. This event will be our "Pre-Pool Opening Cleanup and Potluck". Cleanup activities at the pool will begin at 1:30. After all that hard work, members can go freshen up and reconvene in the BARN at 5:30 for well deserved nourishment !!! It should be a fun day.

THE PRESIDENT'S CORNER:

by Richard Kaufman

As Spring begins to show herself on the mountainside, we are reminded that often it is what you don't see or hear about that is important. In a community association such as ours, vigilance and maintenance are the prices of the systems and services that make it possible for us to enjoy our houses and the surroundings.

These include the water and sewer systems, roads, electric power, security, recreational facilities and other physical features of modern life which we have a right - up to a point - to take for granted. We also have a special responsibility to preserve the woodlands that we have inherited.

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CMA President Richard Kaufman (left) and CMA Operations Manager John Hobday inspect water / sewer installations in the new "T" section which adds 8 lots and 16 acres to the Association common lands.

HAVE YOU RETURNED YOUR BALLOT ON THE PROPOSED CHANGES TO THE COOLFONT COVENANTS? WHILE THERE IS NO TIME LIMIT ON VOTING, PLEASE LET YOUR VIEWS BE KNOWN AS SOON AS POSSIBLE! THANKS!

Our webmaster, Bob Borchers , continues to look for new ideas for the website. Members, please send Bob your good ideas.

Our website is located at http://www.geocities.com/coolfont_mountainside/.

Many newcomers have joined our mountain community including:

Brian and Jean Rubin

James Turner and Betsy Lehrfeld

Gini Sweet

Halli Kerr

James and Christina Chiriaco

Katherine Farquhar

Alice Minnamon continues to handle our "Newcomer Welcomes". If she has not been in touch, she will be soon.

Joan Hash, Chair



RECREATION:

New Bath/Changing Facilities Soon at the Pool!

The CMA Recreation Committee reports that progress is being made on our office/bathroom facility at the pool. The architect has completed the plans, and we have sent them out to four contractors for bids. The building will be located about where the horseshoe pits are, just outside the entrance to the pool.

As Joan Hash mentioned in her column, the Recreation Committee and Social Committee are joining forces to sponsor a pool beautification day, with pot luck dinner in the barn, tentatively scheduled for May 19, 2001. It will be great fun, and the results will be a beautiful pool area for all to enjoy. Let me repeat the invitation: we need volunteers to help with cleaning up the pool area, doing some planting, and setting up for the pot luck. If you're planning to attend, please contact Joan Hash or Marie Barrett.

We need lifeguards for this season, both full-time and as substitutes. If you know of a qualified young person who may be interested, please let Marie know. We plan to have the pool open on weekends (Friday, Saturday, and Sunday) from the Memorial Day weekend through the third week of June, and then every day from June 22 through the Labor Day weekend. You will be getting swim tickets and packets of information in April or early May.

Wouldn't you like to be involved in finalizing the new office/bathroom facility or in helping this year's swim season run smoothly? The Recreation ommittee would love to have you help out! Please contact Marie.

Marie Barrett, Chair

ROADS:

SNOW REMOVAL, IMPROVEMENTS ON COMMITTEE AGENDA

The Roads Committee has three matters to report.

First, we've renewed our contract for snow removal with CRI. (Yes, we know it's March. But some of the strong, old-timers may remember the March of 1913!) There are just a couple provisions that will be of particular interest to homeowners.

Homeowners who wish to have their driveways plowed should call **Maureen Yarrington at 304-258-4500, ext. 7920** in advance of the plowing. The cost is $20.00 for the first 100 feet and $15.00 per additional 100 feet. If the homeowner is late in calling, and the crew must return to plow, the cost is $50.

Second, we've hired Tom Reggleman, former State Superintendent of Roads for our area to take a look at our roads on the mountainside and to give us a plan for maintenance and improvements for the next five years. He promises to have a report to us by the April CMA Board meeting.

Third, the Committee has not followed up on our offer to seek a group rate for gravel and tar and chip orders. We decided to wait out the winter before having any work done. We would like interested parties to let us know again of their interest. E-mail Lon Dring at *lon@dring.org* or call 301-871-8764.

Lon Dring, Chair

Do you have questions about your CMA Water Bill?
Call CMA Treasurer Paul Kagen at
(301) 946-0668 (ofc) or (301) 942-1664 (home)

PRESIDENT'S CORNER, Continued

It takes only one power failure, snow storm, or break in a water line to demonstrate our vulnerability. Fortunately, we are prepared to deal with the usual acts of nature and the normal breakdowns of machinery. The Morgan Messenger recently ran several articles about problems with Berkeley's water system. Among other problems, there are questions about the adequacy of the town's water supply. We are fortunate to have ample sources from our own wells. But we need to be aware that they are not inexhaustible. The measures we have taken to upgrade the water system and to keep it in good repair are resulting in greater conservation of this valuable resource.

In recent months the Board of Directors has taken a number of other steps to maintain and improve the infrastructure. Plans for a combined pool house and office have been completed and we are awaiting responses to invitations for bids for its construction. The newly established Committee on Roads is working on a long- range plan for the roads. A new snow removal agreement has been entered into with Coolfont. We have made good progress in resolving the controversy over the T-section and a final resolution is imminent, we hope. I am grateful for all the hard work of my fellow board members and others who volunteer their time and efforts.

Richard Kaufman

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